

DISTANCE

7.3 mi

TIME

4 hrs

ELEVATION GAIN

1292 ft

SEASON

Spring, Summer, Fall, Winter

HIKE INFO

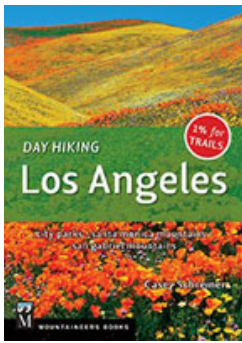


WEATHER

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Featured In

Day Hiking Los Angeles

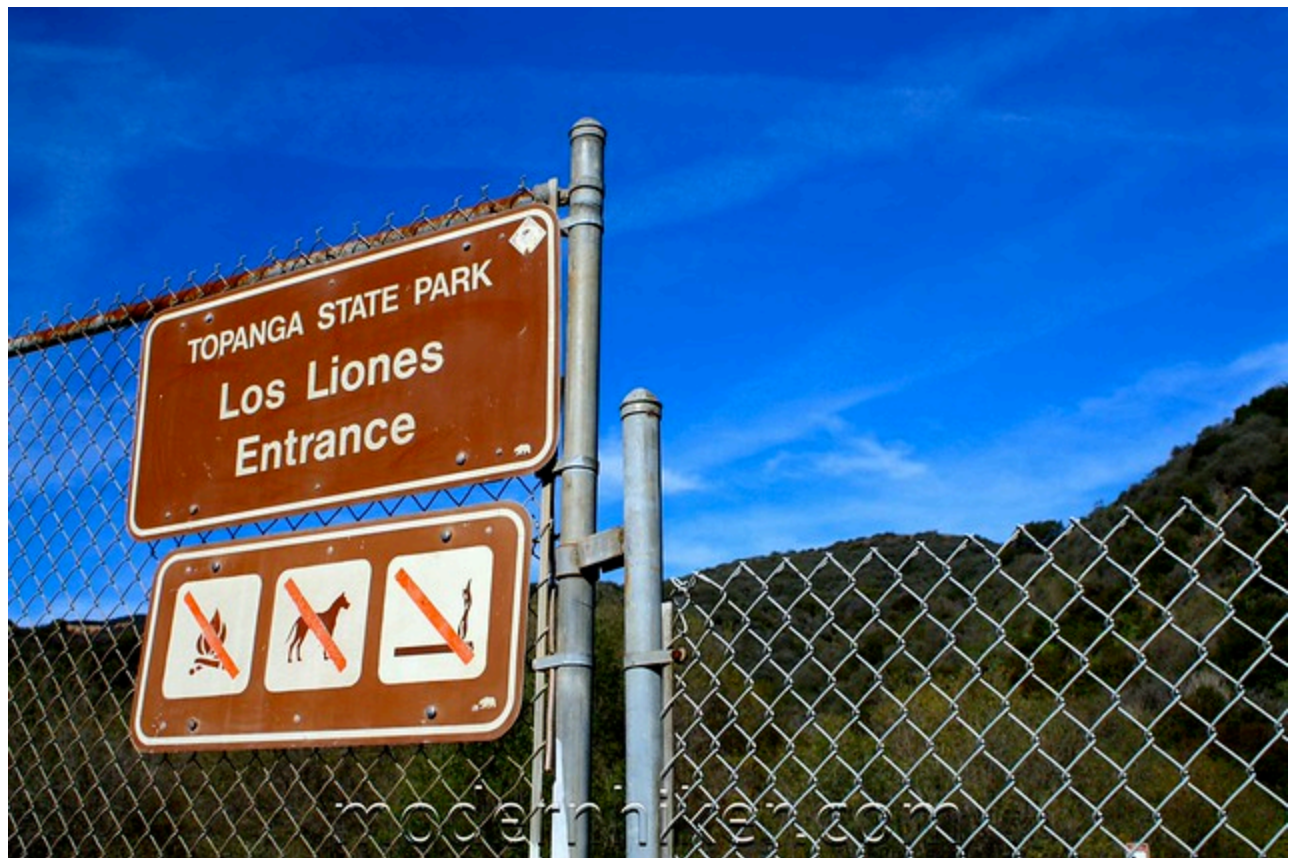


Casey Schreiner

The Los Liones Trail is a 7.3 mile hike from the Pacific Palisades to a popular overlook in Topanga State Park, and is honestly [one of the finest hikes in all of Los Angeles](#). The first part of this hike – the Los Liones Trail – is one of the most lush riparian canyons I’ve seen in the Santa Monica Mountains — particularly in the cooler months of our rainy season. It’s gently graded, moderately shady, and definitely worth a look even if you have to fight crowds. Afterward, the trail meets up with the system of fire roads in Topanga State Park, and makes a relentless ascent to Parker Mesa (1525ft). On a clear day, you’ll get amazing views of the Santa Monica Bay, and often inland as far as the San Bernardino Mountains.

Parker Mesa is a popular overlook of the Pacific Coast in Topanga State Park, but most people reach it on fire roads from the Park’s western entrance. For a much better look at the varied landscapes inside Topanga State Park – and for a much more intense workout – this southern approach is a more interesting route.

The Los Liones Trail starts on Los Liones Drive in the Pacific Palisades at a clearly marked gate. This is a popular trail, but there’s plenty of free street parking, as well as two spillover lots near picnic areas and restrooms. (And yes, we know “lion” in Spanish is “león,” but whoever named this street did not.)



The Los Liones Trail starts out inconspicuously enough, looking like just about any other coastal Southern California trail – but as the single-track route winds its way over several short hills and through the scrub, it starts to take on a character all its own.